



Photograph by AVESH GAUR





It started with a moment of pure, unexpected envy. Decades ago, while walking past a boutique bathroom showroom in the UK, Abhinav Khandelwal found himself staring at custom bathroom setups and realised with sudden clarity that nothing like it existed back home. That singular spark did not just birth a business; it set off a quiet, 25-year revolution in the landscape of Indian design. Long before wellness became a mainstream trend, Khandelwal championed the philosophy that bathrooms could be personal sanctuaries of design, comfort and wellbeing. His unique ability to anticipate shifts, embrace innovation and relentlessly focus on the customer experience has firmly positioned him as a thought leader who helped shape the luxury bath and wellness industry in India. Today, the brand he built, FCML, spans 15 cities, operating less like a traditional retailer and more like an elite design laboratory.

Organic Metamorphosis

"We don't differentiate between product lines," Khandelwal notes, reflecting a philosophy that treats every corner of the home with equal reverence. "Each design is as dear to us as the other." This egalitarian view of space explains FCML's rhythmic, highly organic expansion. Like a well-composed home, the brand grew room by room, layer by layer. Every three to four years over its quarter-century journey, it innovated, adding bespoke tiles, wooden flooring and kitchens to its repertoire. The common thread? A stubborn refusal to compromise on quality, transitioning away from institutional, volume-heavy projects to focus almost entirely on the uncompromising world of high-end private residences.

STAND OUT LAYOUTS

FCML Ahmedabad flagship store designed by Rajiv and Ekta Parekh, reD Architects (far left and middle); FCML Bangalore extension floor designed by Vritima Wadhwa, Project 810 (right and below); Abhinav Khandelwal (above)